



Delaware County Commissioners Meeting September 20th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GGk6XCEMNGU
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: September 20, 2021

Prepared by: Expert Civic Analyst

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Commissioners was called to order by the presiding officer on Monday, September 20, 2021, at 9:00 AM.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Henry, Mr. Reagan (President), and Mr. King. (Note: Mr. Burke is also recorded as present during roll call).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Reagan.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.

- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll call vote recorded: Mr. Henry, yes; Mr. Reagan, yes; Mr. King, yes) for the September 7, 2021 commissioners meeting minutes.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:07 Public Hearing: American Rescue Plan (ARP) Funding**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Delaware County Commissioners / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board opened a public hearing to discuss the allocation and spending of federal American Rescue Plan (ARP) relief funds during the pandemic. Commissioners noted federal guidelines restrict spending parameters.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:01:27 Yancer Author** (Former newsman, We the People): Spoke regarding federal relief spending. Expressed concern over lack of people-based programs, suggested local stimulus checks or utility/property tax relief for citizens facing recent utility and tax hikes, and questioned jail maintenance funding and utility allocations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Following public comment and noting the absence of other speakers, a motion to close the public hearing passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **00:05:54 Ordinance No. 2021-026: Ordinance to Limit Weight and Commercial Truck Traffic**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Attorney / Staff / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** This ordinance, proposed approximately a month prior, was brought forward from table business. Revised with input from county staff and attorneys to ensure specific bridge and road weight restrictions in the county code are preserved. The measure keeps commercial vehicles weighing 26,000 pounds or greater off designated county roads, particularly unofficial state detours, while including standard exceptions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to remove from table: Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Reagan, yes; Mr. Henry, yes; Mr. King, yes).
 - Motion to adopt Ordinance 2021-026: Passed by roll call vote (Mr. Henry, yes; Mr. Reagan, yes; Mr. King, yes).
- **00:07:51 Contracts and Agreements: American Rescue Plan (ARP) Plan Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners and Counsel (Joe).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented revisions to the updated American Rescue Plan spending plan sent to commissioners over the weekend. Adjustments included

removing the Daleville area interceptor/regional wastewater district overlook project, as well as the Town of Eaton water project (which was removed because its large USDA grant funding could be jeopardized by local matching funds). Total funding remains under the \$11 million allocated to the county. Revenue replacement allocations were left to the County Council's determination.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote. *(Note: Commissioners emphasized that final appropriation of funds rests with the County Council).*
- **00:10:02 Ordinance No. 2021-027: Ordinance Amending Traffic Regulations (Stop Signs)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Traffic Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of an ordinance to establish new stop signs near the county reservoir. Because new stop signs are being added, a statutory public hearing is scheduled for the next meeting on October 4th.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced for first reading. Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Reagan, yes; Mr. Henry, yes; Mr. King, yes).
- **00:10:53 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Auditor / Finance.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of claims totaling \$2,004,287.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Henry, yes; Mr. Reagan, yes; Mr. King, yes).
- **00:11:24 Hilltop Hotel Property Redevelopment Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout, Delaware County Economic Development / Redevelopment.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Bookout advised the board that the former hilltop hotel property previously awarded to the Veterans Foundation of Delaware County has experienced a project direction change, and funding is no longer available to execute the original project. He recommended the county rescind the property award and take it back from the foundation. The county attorney was directed to draft a resolution/RFP mechanism (potentially involving the East Central Regional Planning District) to repurpose the property.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to take the hilltop property back from the Indiana Veterans Foundation to the county passed by roll call vote (Mr. Reagan, yes; Mr. Henry, yes; Mr. King, yes).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:13:38 Jane Miranda** (Delaware County Community Corrections):
 - Spoke during the departmental/citizen input period regarding the county's COVID relief proposal. Highlighted increased substance abuse, domestic violence, and mental health issues resulting from the pandemic. Urged the commissioners to

reconsider their ARP funding allocations to include financial support for Community Corrections' substance abuse and domestic violence classes, noting that smaller local agencies are closing due to a lack of funding while capital projects receive priority.

- **00:15:36 Tim Merkel** (Resident and business owner, Merck's Family Dining):
 - Stated he and his wife own Merck's Family Dining near the airport. Expressed severe financial losses incurred during the COVID-19 pandemic, including a three-month closure relying strictly on carryout. Inquired about financial relief options made available through the county. Commissioners advised that small business relief funding would be channeled through the Visitors Bureau once the ARP plan receives final council appropriation.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Reminder regarding the upcoming public hearing for Ordinance 2021-027 scheduled for October 4th.
 - Clarification provided regarding the ARP process: the Commissioners propose the plan and submit an appropriation request, but the County Council holds final authority to approve appropriations under State Board of Accounts rules.
- **Adjournment:**
 - A motion to recess was made, seconded, and approved by roll call vote (Mr. Henry, yes; Mr. Reagan, yes; Mr. King, yes). Meeting recessed.